

What is Playwright — and Why Does Artistly Gallery Use It?

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Playwright is a browser automation tool that lets the app control a real web browser on your behalf — opening pages, waiting for content to appear, and clicking buttons exactly as you would. In Artistly Gallery, Playwright handles the cloud operations that would otherwise require you to manually page through your entire Personal Designs library.

What Playwright Actually Does in This App

Playwright is used for three types of cloud operations, all triggered from the Control Center:

Task	What Playwright Does
Cloud Sync	Opens your Personal Designs page and captures your library data as each page loads, saving it to a local data file. Clicks "Load More" to work through your full library. Also handles downloading your images from Artistly as part of the sync process when direct image retrieval is not available.
Bulk Move	Opens your Artistly library in the browser, locates the flagged designs, and moves them to the destination folder on your behalf.
Bulk Delete	Same as Bulk Move, but removes the flagged designs from your Artistly account.

During Cloud Sync, the app intentionally pauses for 2–5 seconds between pages — this keeps the pace human-like and avoids putting unnecessary load on Artistly's servers.

Which Browser Does It Use?

This depends on your platform:

On Windows: Playwright uses your installed **Google Chrome** or **Microsoft Edge** as the browser engine — Chrome first, Edge as a fallback. No separate browser is installed by the app.

On Mac (packaged .app): The app bundles its own browser. This is necessary because macOS doesn't provide a system browser that the app can use outside the bundle.

In both cases, Playwright uses a **dedicated profile stored in the app's own data folder** — completely separate from your personal browser. Your own bookmarks, history, saved passwords, and extensions are never touched.

The "Chrome is Being Controlled" Notification

When a cloud operation launches, Chrome or Edge may show a bar at the top of the browser window saying something like *"Chrome is being controlled by automated test software."*

This is expected and harmless. It appears any time an application drives Chrome or Edge in automation mode. It is not a sign of anything malicious or broken — you can safely dismiss or ignore it.

How Login Works

Because Playwright uses a dedicated profile (not your personal one), it maintains its own separate login session for Artistly.

First sync: The browser will open to your Artistly Personal Designs page. If you haven't logged in through the app before, Artistly will redirect you to its login page. Log in as you normally would, then return to the Personal Designs page and press Enter in the app terminal when prompted. Once you're logged in, the app saves your session to its data folder and reuses it automatically from that point on — you won't need to log in again unless the session expires.

Subsequent syncs: Your saved session is loaded automatically. No login required.

When You Will Need to Log In Again

You will see a login prompt again in these situations:

1. **Session expiry:** Artistly expires login sessions after a period of inactivity. When this happens, the app detects the redirect and pauses, asking you to log in again.
2. **Security checks:** If Artistly presents a CAPTCHA or a two-factor authentication prompt, the app will pause and wait for you to complete it before continuing.
3. **Manual logout or reinstall:** If you log out within the Playwright-controlled browser, clear the app's data folder, or do a clean reinstall, the saved session is removed and you'll start fresh with a new login.